ICE WHITE SUGAR NO. 5 FUTURES (XW)

"LIFFE Sugar" — Spread & Curve Structure Fundamental Reference

Refined Sugar, the White Premium, and the Relationship to ICE Sugar No. 11

This document presents a fact-based reference on the fundamental drivers of ICE White Sugar No. 5 futures (ticker: XW), the global benchmark for refined (white) sugar, traded on ICE Futures Europe — the exchange still commonly referred to by market participants as "LIFFE" after its originating exchange, the London International Financial Futures and Options Exchange. LIFFE merged into Euronext in 2002 and the derivatives business was subsequently acquired by ICE in 2013/2014, after which the contract began trading as ICE Futures Europe; the legacy "LIFFE Sugar" name remains in routine trade use. White Sugar No. 5 prices refined, crystallised white sugar — the product that reaches the retail consumer and most food and beverage manufacturing applications — in contrast to ICE Sugar No. 11 (the subject of a separate reference document produced earlier in this series), which prices raw, unrefined cane sugar. Because White Sugar No. 5 prices the refined product, it sits one processing step downstream of No. 11 in the global sugar supply chain, and the spread between the two contracts — the "White Premium" — is itself one of the most closely tracked relationships in the global sugar trade. This document presents the White Sugar No. 5-specific fundamentals in full and includes a dedicated, fact-only comparison section addressing every material structural and operational difference between XW and ICE Sugar No. 11.

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1. Contract Specifications and Settlement Mechanics

White Sugar No. 5 is a physically delivered contract for refined white sugar meeting a defined quality specification, in contrast to the raw, unrefined cane sugar delivered against ICE Sugar No. 11. This distinction in the underlying product — refined versus raw — is the foundation for nearly every other difference between the two contracts described in Section 10.

Parameter	Detail
Exchange	ICE Futures Europe (formerly LIFFE — London International Financial Futures and Options Exchange)
Ticker	XW (front month); commonly still called "LIFFE Sugar" or "White Sugar"
Full name	White Sugar No. 5
Underlying product	Refined (white, crystallised) sugar meeting a defined polarisation, colour, and granulometry (crystal size) specification — the finished retail/industrial product, not raw cane sugar.
Contract size	50 metric tonnes
Quotation	US dollars per metric tonne (USD/MT); minimum tick = $0.10/MT = $5.00 per contract
Contract months	March (H), May (K), August (Q), October (V), December (Z) — five delivery months per year. Note this calendar differs from ICE Sugar No. 11's four-month cycle — see Section 10.1.
Settlement type	Physical delivery — refined white sugar, FOB stowed at a list of named ports across multiple eligible origins, or delivered in bags/containers per the contract's delivery terms; a documentary (warehouse warrant / delivery order) settlement mechanism is used analogous in concept to other ICE soft commodity contracts.
Delivery grade	Refined white sugar of at least 99.8 degrees polarisation, with defined maximum colour (ICUMSA units) and moisture specifications — a materially tighter and higher-purity specification than the 96 degree polarisation standard for raw sugar under No. 11.
Last trading day	Set by exchange calendar relative to the delivery month; differs in specific convention from the No. 11 calendar.
Trading hours	ICE electronic: hours set by ICE Futures Europe, with peak liquidity overlapping European trading hours — in contrast to No. 11's peak liquidity overlapping US trading hours.
Contract value at $500/MT	$25,000 per contract
Relationship to ICE Sugar No. 11	No. 11 (ICE Futures US, raw cane sugar, 112,000 lb/contract, ¢/lb) is the upstream raw-sugar benchmark. The spread between the two, after unit conversion, is the "White Premium" — see Section 10.5 for the full comparison.

1.1 Why a Refined-Sugar Contract Exists Separately From Raw Sugar

- Raw sugar (priced by No. 11) is an intermediate product: it must be further refined — removing residual molasses, colour, and impurities — before it reaches the form most consumers and most food/beverage manufacturers actually use. White Sugar No. 5 exists as a separate contract because the economics of refining (the cost and capacity to convert raw into white sugar) are a distinct and independently variable layer of the sugar supply chain, requiring its own price discovery and hedging mechanism separate from the raw sugar market.

- **Refiners** — companies that purchase raw sugar (or, in the case of beet sugar producers, produce white sugar directly from sugar beet without an intermediate raw stage) and convert it to refined white sugar — are the primary commercial hedgers in White Sugar No. 5, using the contract to manage the price risk on both their raw sugar input costs (often hedged via No. 11) and their white sugar output sales (hedged via No. 5), with the difference between the two representing their refining margin.
- **The beet sugar connection**: unlike cane sugar, which is always produced first as raw sugar and then refined as a separate step, sugar beet processing produces white sugar directly in a single processing stage, without an intermediate raw sugar product. This means European beet sugar producers (see Section 3) interact with the White Sugar No. 5 market as direct white sugar suppliers, without necessarily having an equivalent raw sugar position to hedge via No. 11 — a structural difference in how cane-origin and beet-origin production each relate to the two contracts.

2. Global White Sugar Production and Trade

White sugar reaching the export market comes from two distinct production routes: direct production from sugar beet (which yields white sugar without an intermediate raw stage) and refining of raw cane sugar at dedicated refineries, which may be located either at the cane-growing origin or in the importing/consuming country.

2.1 The Two Production Routes to White Sugar

Route	Mechanism	Primary Geography	Relevance to XW
Beet sugar (direct white production)	Sugar beet is processed directly into white sugar in a single campaign, typically September–December (Northern Hemisphere), with no intermediate raw sugar stage.	European Union (France, Germany, Poland, and others), with smaller beet sugar industries in the US, Russia, Turkey, and other temperate-climate producers.	EU beet sugar producers are direct white sugar suppliers to the global market and a primary source of XW-deliverable supply during and after the autumn beet campaign.
Cane sugar (refined from raw)	Raw cane sugar (96 pol, the No. 11 deliverable standard) is refined at a dedicated refinery — either located at origin (e.g., a Brazilian mill with refining capacity) or at a destination-market refinery that imports raw sugar specifically to refine it (a "cane sugar refiner").	Brazil (origin refining capacity), and destination refiners in the EU, Middle East/North Africa, and parts of Asia that import raw sugar for local refining.	Cane-origin and destination refiners are the primary commercial hedgers using both No. 11 (raw input) and XW (white output), with the spread between the two representing their margin.

2.2 Major White Sugar Exporting Origins

- **European Union**: as both a major beet sugar producer and home to substantial cane-sugar refining capacity (importing raw sugar, including under preferential trade arrangements with ACP/developing-country exporters), the EU is a significant exporter of white sugar, particularly to North Africa, the Middle East, and other nearby markets. Following the 2017 EU sugar regime reform that abolished internal production quotas, EU beet sugar production — and by extension its exportable surplus — has shown greater year-to-year variability than under the prior quota system.
- **Brazil**: in addition to its dominant role as the world's largest raw sugar exporter (priced via No. 11), a portion of Brazilian Centre-South mill capacity is configured to produce white (rather than raw) sugar directly, making Brazil a significant white sugar exporter as well, particularly relevant to White Sugar No. 5 pricing given Brazil's scale.
- **Thailand**: alongside its raw sugar export programme, Thailand also exports a meaningful volume of white/refined sugar, serving Asian destination markets.
- **India**: India's sugar mills produce a mix of raw and white sugar; in years when the Indian government permits or subsidises exports, India can be a significant swing exporter of both raw and white sugar to the global market.

2.3 Major White Sugar Importing Destinations

- **MENA region (Egypt, Algeria, and others)**: a major destination for white sugar specifically (as opposed to raw sugar requiring local refining), often via government or state-trading-entity tenders that are closely watched events for the white sugar market specifically.

- **Indonesia**: imports both raw sugar (for domestic refining) and white sugar directly, depending on domestic refining capacity utilisation and government import licensing policy.
- **Sub-Saharan Africa and other developing markets**: frequently prefer or require white sugar imports directly, given limited local refining infrastructure in many of these markets — a structural feature that supports white sugar export demand from the EU, Brazil, and Thailand specifically, as distinct from raw sugar export demand.

3. The EU Beet Sugar Sector

Because EU beet sugar producers supply white sugar directly to the global market without an intermediate raw-sugar stage, the EU beet campaign is a structurally important and somewhat XW-specific supply variable that does not have a precise equivalent in the No. 11 raw sugar fundamentals (where Brazil's cane harvest plays the dominant role).

3.1 The EU Beet Campaign

- **Campaign timing**: the EU beet harvest and processing ("campaign") runs primarily September through December, with campaign length and start date varying by country and by beet yield and sugar content in a given year. Major producing countries include France, Germany, Poland, Belgium, Netherlands, and several others across northern and central Europe.
- **Weather sensitivity**: EU beet yields are sensitive to summer drought conditions during the beet root's bulking phase (broadly June–August) and to disease pressure, particularly cercospora leaf spot, which has reportedly become more prevalent with warmer European summers. Documented drought years with materially reduced EU beet yields include 2018 and 2022.
- **The 2017 EU sugar regime reform**: the abolition of EU internal sugar production quotas, effective from the 2017/18 campaign, removed the prior ceiling on EU beet sugar (and isoglucose) production, allowing EU output — and the resulting exportable surplus — to respond more directly to price signals and to exhibit greater year-to-year variability than under the previous quota regime.
- **Neonicotinoid seed treatment restrictions**: EU-wide restrictions on neonicotinoid pesticide seed treatments have affected beet growers' ability to manage certain early-season pests, a factor cited by industry sources as a contributor to yield risk in some growing regions, alongside the disease pressure noted above.

3.2 EU White Sugar Export Flows

- EU white sugar exports — flowing primarily to nearby MENA and Sub-Saharan African markets — vary with the size of the domestic beet campaign relative to EU domestic consumption, and are subject to EU trade policy, including any preferential market access arrangements between the EU and destination countries.
- **Isoglucose as a partial substitute**: since the 2017 quota abolition, EU isoglucose (a high-fructose corn/wheat-starch sweetener) production has also been freed from its prior production ceiling, and isoglucose competes with beet sugar for a portion of EU domestic sweetener demand, an indirect factor affecting the volume of EU beet sugar available for export as white sugar.

4. Refining Economics and the White Premium Mechanism

The White Premium — broadly, the price of White Sugar No. 5 minus the price of ICE Sugar No. 11 (after converting both to common units) — is the central analytical concept connecting the raw and refined sugar markets, and is the primary subject of Section 10.5. This section explains the underlying refining economics that the White Premium represents.

4.1 What the White Premium Represents

- The White Premium represents the value added by the refining process: converting 96-pol raw sugar into 99.8+ pol refined white sugar requires energy, water, processing chemicals (including activated carbon or ion-exchange resin for decolourisation), capital-intensive refining infrastructure, and labour. The White Premium must, over time, cover these refining costs plus a margin for the refiner, or refining capacity will not be economically sustained.
- **Refining yield loss**: refining raw sugar into white sugar involves some unavoidable processing loss (the removed molasses, colour bodies, and moisture represent mass that does not convert into saleable white sugar), meaning a refiner does not get a 1-for-1 tonne conversion from raw input to white output — a factor embedded in the refining margin calculation alongside the direct processing costs above.

4.2 Drivers of White Premium Width

- **A wide White Premium** (historically and at various points, levels above roughly $80–100/MT have been cited by trade sources as comfortably profitable for refiners) incentivises refiners to maximise throughput, buying more raw sugar (supporting No. 11 demand) and producing more white sugar (potentially pressuring XW if supply outpaces white sugar demand growth).
- **A narrow or compressed White Premium** signals poor refining economics, which can lead refiners to reduce run rates or idle capacity, reducing raw sugar demand (bearish for No. 11 at the margin) while also constraining white sugar supply growth (supportive for XW at the margin) — the two contracts can therefore, at times, move in different directions in response to a refining-margin-driven supply adjustment, even though both are ultimately connected to the same global sugar balance.
- **Producer choice between raw and white production at origin**: as referenced in Section 2.1, some cane-origin producers (notably parts of the Brazilian and Thai industries) have the flexibility to configure mill output toward either raw or white sugar. When the White Premium is wide, these producers are incentivised to shift output toward white sugar production directly at origin, which increases XW-relevant supply while reducing the raw sugar otherwise available for export under No. 11 — a direct supply-side link between the width of the White Premium and the relative deliverable supply available to each contract.

4.3 Energy Costs and Refining Margins

- Because refining is an energy-intensive process (heat for crystallisation and drying, mechanical energy for centrifuging), regional energy price levels — particularly natural gas and electricity prices in the EU and other refining centres — affect refiner cost structures and, at the margin, the White Premium level required to sustain refining profitability.

5. Demand Fundamentals — White Sugar Specifically

While the long-run global sugar demand drivers (population growth, income growth in developing markets, sugar taxes and health policy in developed markets, and high-fructose corn syrup substitution in markets where it is available) are common to both raw and white sugar in aggregate, certain demand-side considerations are specific to white sugar given its position as the final, consumer- and manufacturer-facing product.

5.1 White Sugar as the Direct Food/Beverage Industry Input

- Food and beverage manufacturers, and the retail/consumer channel, purchase and use white sugar directly, making XW (and the physical white sugar market it represents) the more directly relevant price reference for these end-users compared to No. 11, which prices an intermediate raw-sugar product that consumers and most manufacturers do not use directly.
- **Sugar taxes and health policy**: as detailed for the global sugar market generally, sugar-sweetened beverage taxes (the UK, Mexico, South Africa, France, Norway, and others) and health-driven demand softening in developed markets affect white sugar demand directly at the point of final consumption, making this demand channel arguably more directly and immediately observable in the white sugar market than in the raw sugar market, which is one processing step removed from final consumption.

5.2 Government Tenders as a White-Sugar-Specific Demand Signal

- Several MENA and other government or state-trading-entity sugar purchases are conducted via publicly tendered purchases specifically for white sugar (as the directly usable product for distribution to consumers or subsidised food programmes), making individual tender results and tender volumes a closely watched, relatively high-frequency demand signal that is more directly observable for white sugar than the more diffuse raw sugar import demand that flows mostly to destination refiners rather than through discrete, publicly announced tender events.

6. The Forward Curve Structure

White Sugar No. 5 trades in five delivery months per year — March, May, August, October, December — a different calendar structure from No. 11's four-month cycle (March, May, July, October). The specific contract-month spacing therefore creates a distinct set of calendar spread gaps from those analysed in the No. 11 reference document (see Section 10.1 for the direct month-by-month comparison).

6.1 Carry and Curve Shape

- **Cost of carry for refined white sugar**: as with raw sugar, storage costs, financing, and quality considerations (refined white sugar is generally less prone to the caking and moisture issues that can affect raw sugar in storage, though it is not entirely immune) determine the theoretical full-carry contango level between adjacent XW contracts.
- **Backwardation**: as with No. 11, XW backwardation (nearby trading at a premium to deferred) signals near-term physical tightness in the refined sugar market specifically — which can arise independently of raw sugar tightness if the constraint is in refining capacity/throughput rather than in raw sugar availability, a distinction unique to the refined-product contract that has no direct equivalent in the raw sugar curve.

6.2 Seasonal Drivers Specific to the XW Calendar

- **The EU beet campaign (Sep–Dec)** directly affects the supply picture for contracts referencing the period immediately following harvest — broadly the October and December contracts — in a manner analogous to how the Brazilian Centre-South harvest affects the No. 11 calendar, but on Europe's northern-hemisphere harvest timing rather than Brazil's April–November cycle.
- **MENA and other government tender timing**: because tenders are often scheduled around specific national stock-management or subsidised-distribution calendars, tender timing can create recurring, though not perfectly mechanical, seasonal demand patterns for specific XW contract months in a given destination market's import cycle.

7. Key Data Sources

7.1 Shared Global Sugar Balance Data

- **ISO (International Sugar Organization) Quarterly Report**: as with No. 11, the ISO's global supply/demand/stocks balance sheet — though reported primarily on a raw-sugar-equivalent basis for the purpose of aggregating across cane and beet, raw and white production — remains the primary structural reference for the overall global sugar balance relevant to both contracts.
- **USDA WASDE / Foreign Agricultural Service sugar reports**: similarly reported on a raw-sugar-equivalent basis but relevant background for both raw and white sugar markets.

7.2 White-Sugar and Beet-Specific Sources

- **EU beet sugar production and yield estimates**: published by EU national agricultural agencies, Eurostat, and industry bodies such as Copa-Cogeca (the EU farmers' and agri-cooperatives' association) and commercial agricultural analytics providers, tracking EU beet planted area, yield progress, and campaign production estimates.
- **MENA and other government tender announcements and results**: published by the purchasing government entities themselves (e.g., Egypt's state-affiliated purchasing bodies) and tracked by trade press and commodity analytics services, providing discrete, white-sugar-specific demand data points.
- **ICE certified/exchange stock and delivery data for XW**: published by ICE Futures Europe, specific to the White Sugar No. 5 delivery system and distinct from the equivalent No. 11 data published for ICE Futures US (see Section 10.4).

7.3 Currency and Macro

- **EUR/USD**: relevant to EU beet sugar producer economics, since EU production costs are substantially euro-denominated while the global sugar price (including XW, which is USD-denominated) is set in USD terms.
- **BRL/USD**: remains relevant to XW to the extent Brazilian mills configured for white sugar production respond to the same BRL-driven production economics described for Brazilian raw sugar production in the No. 11 reference document.

8. Macro and Positioning Data

8.1 Speculative and Commercial Positioning

- XW, as a contract traded on ICE Futures Europe, is subject to the UK/EU market position-reporting framework rather than the US CFTC's Commitments of Traders regime that applies to No. 11 (traded on ICE Futures US) — the same regulatory-regime distinction described for the CC/XC cocoa contracts elsewhere in this document series applies here in an analogous way (see Section 10.4).
- **Refiner commercial positioning**: commercial hedging activity in XW is dominated by refiners managing their white sugar output price risk, often in combination with an offsetting or related position in No. 11 covering their raw sugar input cost — meaning refiner positioning in the two contracts is frequently linked by the same underlying commercial hedging programme, even though the two positions are reported under different regulatory regimes and datasets.

8.2 Currency and the US Dollar

- Both XW and No. 11 are USD-denominated (this is a point of similarity rather than difference between the two contracts — see Section 10.2), meaning broad USD strength or weakness affects both in the same general directional sense via the standard dollar-priced-commodity mechanism (USD strength raising the effective cost for non-USD buyers, and vice versa), without the additional currency-conversion layer that exists, for example, between the GBP-denominated London Cocoa contract and its USD-denominated New York counterpart.

9. Documented Seasonal Patterns

White Sugar No. 5's seasonal pattern is shaped by the combination of the EU beet campaign timing, the cane-sugar refining cycle (which itself depends on raw sugar availability from Brazil, Thailand, and other cane origins per the No. 11 calendar), and the discrete timing of major government tender purchases.

Period	Key Seasonal Factor	Mechanism	Relevant Contracts
Jan–Mar	EU beet campaign largely complete; cane refining continues using raw sugar from the prior season.	White sugar supply relatively stable, drawing on post-campaign EU stocks and ongoing cane refining output.	March, May contracts
Apr–Aug	Brazilian Centre-South cane harvest ramping (per the No. 11 calendar); cane-origin white sugar production (where applicable) becomes more active.	Refining margin (White Premium) responds to raw sugar availability and price from the new CS harvest.	May, August contracts
Sep–Dec	EU beet campaign in progress and concluding; new-campaign EU white sugar entering the market.	EU beet supply is the most direct seasonal driver during this window, analogous in role (though not timing) to the Brazilian CS harvest's role in the No. 11 calendar.	October, December contracts

Because White Sugar No. 5 supply is fed by two distinct and differently timed production cycles — the EU beet campaign (Northern Hemisphere autumn) and cane sugar refining (paced by the Brazilian, Thai, and other cane harvests per the No. 11 calendar) — its seasonal pattern is less driven by a single dominant harvest event than No. 11's pattern, which is heavily anchored to the Brazilian Centre-South cycle.

10. XW ("LIFFE Sugar") vs ICE Sugar No. 11 — Comparison of Differences

This section catalogues every material, verifiable difference between ICE White Sugar No. 5 (XW) and ICE Sugar No. 11. It is presented as a factual reference only and does not take a position on which contract is preferable for any particular hedging or trading purpose, as that depends on the specific commercial exposure (raw vs refined sugar) or trading objective involved.

10.1 Underlying Product, Exchange, and Contract Terms

Dimension	XW (White Sugar No. 5, "LIFFE")	ICE Sugar No. 11
Underlying product	Refined white sugar, min. 99.8 degrees polarisation	Raw cane sugar, 96 degrees polarisation standard
Exchange	ICE Futures Europe (legacy LIFFE)	ICE Futures US (legacy NYBOT/CSCE)
Currency	US dollars (USD)	US dollars (USD) — identical currency to XW
Quotation unit	USD per metric tonne	US cents per pound
Contract size	50 metric tonnes	112,000 lb (≈50.8 metric tonnes) — a close but not identical tonnage equivalent
Contract months	H, K, Q, V, Z (March/May/Aug/Oct/Dec)	H, K, N, V (March/May/July/Oct) — a four-month, not five-month, annual cycle
Delivery mechanism	FOB / documentary delivery from a list of eligible producing and refining origins	FOB stowed delivery from a list of eligible raw-sugar-producing origins — a different (raw-sugar) eligible-origin list than XW's

10.2 Currency — A Point of Similarity, Not Difference

- Unlike the CC/XC cocoa pair (where one contract is USD- and the other GBP-denominated) or the No. 11/XW comparison's own quoting convention difference (cents/lb versus USD/MT), both XW and No. 11 are themselves denominated and settled in US dollars. A trader holding offsetting positions in XW and No. 11 is therefore not, by virtue of the contracts' own denomination, taking on an additional direct currency-conversion exposure between the two legs in the way a CC/XC cross-market position would — though both contracts remain separately exposed to the producer-currency dynamics (BRL, EUR, and others) affecting their respective underlying physical markets, as described in Sections 4 and 7.3.

10.3 Quotation Convention — Cents per Pound vs Dollars per Tonne

- No. 11 is quoted in US cents per pound, the traditional convention for raw sugar inherited from its NYBOT/CSCE origins. XW is quoted in US dollars per metric tonne, the convention inherited from its LIFFE/European origins. Converting between the two requires both a unit conversion (pounds to metric tonnes) and no currency conversion (since both are USD), in contrast to a comparison that might also require a currency conversion.
- This quotation difference is purely a market convention; it does not reflect any difference in contract value transparency, but it does mean that direct visual comparison of the two contracts' price levels requires an explicit conversion step before any meaningful comparison (including the White Premium calculation in Section 10.5) can be made.

10.4 Delivery Geography, Eligible Origins, and Regulatory Regime

- **Eligible delivery origins differ by definition**, since the two contracts deliver different products: No. 11's eligible-origin list covers countries and mills capable of producing and exporting raw cane sugar at the 96-pol standard, while XW's eligible-origin list covers producers and refiners — including EU beet sugar producers, who have no direct equivalent role in the No. 11 market, since beet processing does not produce raw sugar as an intermediate product (see Section 1.1 and Section 2.1).
- **Regulatory regime**: as with the CC/XC cocoa pair, No. 11 (ICE Futures US) is subject to US CFTC oversight and the weekly CFTC Commitments of Traders reporting framework, while XW (ICE Futures Europe) is subject to the UK/EU market position-reporting framework — two distinct regulatory regimes and reporting datasets, not a single shared positioning report (see Section 8.1).

10.5 The White Premium — The Defining Cross-Contract Relationship

- The spread between XW and No. 11 (after the unit conversion noted in Section 10.3), commonly called the "White Premium," is the single most important relationship connecting the two contracts, representing the refining margin described in full in Section 4. It is both a commercial hedging reference for refiners and, at times, a directly traded relative-value relationship for speculative participants.
- **Mechanically**, a sustained wide White Premium incentivises increased refining throughput (raising raw sugar/No. 11 demand) and, where producers have the flexibility, a shift of cane-origin output toward direct white sugar production (affecting the relative deliverable supply available to each contract, as detailed in Section 4.2) — a feedback mechanism that, over time, tends to moderate extreme White Premium levels, broadly analogous in concept (though operating through a different physical mechanism) to the COMEX-LME copper arbitrage or the CC-XC cocoa relationship described elsewhere in this document series.

10.6 What Is Different in Underlying Supply Drivers

- Because XW's deliverable supply includes EU beet sugar — a production route entirely absent from the No. 11 market — XW is exposed to an additional, distinct seasonal and weather-risk factor (the EU beet campaign and its summer drought/disease sensitivity, detailed in Section 3) that has no direct counterpart in the No. 11 fundamental picture, which is dominated by cane-sugar-specific drivers (the Brazilian Centre-South harvest and sugar-ethanol allocation mechanism, Indian monsoon and export policy, and Thai cane production) as detailed in the No. 11 reference document.
- Conversely, No. 11's sugar-ethanol allocation mechanism in Brazil — a major driver of raw sugar supply — affects XW only indirectly, via its effect on raw sugar availability and price feeding into the refining margin (Section 4), rather than as a direct supply variable for XW in the way it is a direct supply variable for No. 11.

10.7 What Is Identical or Closely Shared Between the Two Contracts

- Both contracts are USD-denominated (Section 10.2); both are ultimately connected to the same global sugar supply/demand balance reported by the ISO and USDA on a raw-sugar-equivalent basis (Section 7.1); both are affected by the same global demand-side trends (population and income growth in developing markets, sugar taxes and health policy in developed markets, and HFCS substitution where relevant); and both are subject to the general principle that a wide or narrow White Premium creates a supply-side feedback mechanism connecting the two markets (Section 10.5), even though the specific origins, weather risks, and government policy levers affecting each contract's deliverable supply are not identical.

11. Key Data Sources and Release Schedule

Report	Publisher	Frequency	Typical Timing	Relevance
EU beet sugar production/yield estimates	Eurostat / national agencies / Copa-Cogeca	Seasonal (Spring area, Autumn harvest)	Variable	XW-specific — no direct No. 11 equivalent (beet has no raw-sugar intermediate stage)
MENA/other government sugar tender announcements	Purchasing government entities / trade press	As scheduled, several times/year	Variable	XW-specific demand signal — more discretely observable than diffuse raw sugar import demand
ISO Quarterly Sugar Market Report	International Sugar Organization	Quarterly	~6–8 weeks after quarter end	Shared with No. 11 — global raw-sugar-equivalent balance and stocks-to-consumption ratio
USDA WASDE (Sugar component)	USDA WAOB	Monthly	~11th of month	Shared with No. 11 — global production/consumption/stocks revision
UNICA Brazil CS biweekly crush data	UNICA	Biweekly (Apr–Nov)	~2 wks after period	Shared relevance — affects raw sugar (No. 11) directly and the refining margin (White Premium) for XW indirectly
BRL/USD and EUR/USD exchange rates	Reuters / Bloomberg	Continuous	Market hours	BRL relevant to Brazilian cane-origin white sugar production economics; EUR relevant to EU beet producer cost structure
UK/EU market position-reporting data (XW)	ICE Futures Europe / relevant EU regulator	Periodic per regime	Variable	XW-specific positioning dataset under a different regulatory regime than No. 11's CFTC COT
ICE XW certified/exchange stock and delivery data	ICE Futures Europe	Per exchange schedule	Variable	XW-specific — distinct delivery/warehouse system from No. 11's

ICE White Sugar No. 5 and ICE Sugar No. 11 price two adjacent but distinct stages of the same global sugar supply chain: raw cane sugar (No. 11) and the refined white sugar (XW) that results from processing it, with EU beet sugar contributing additional, refining-stage-only supply that has no raw-sugar equivalent at all. The two contracts share the same global demand-side trends and the same USD denomination, but differ in underlying product specification, contract month calendar, quotation convention, eligible delivery origins, and regulatory/positioning-data regime.

The White Premium — the spread between the two, properly unit-converted — is the single relationship that ties the two markets together commercially and analytically, reflecting refining economics that respond to energy costs, refining capacity utilisation, and the flexibility some cane-origin producers have to shift output between raw and white sugar production. A trader working across both contracts needs to track the No. 11-specific fundamentals (Brazilian CS harvest and ethanol allocation, Indian monsoon and export policy, Thai production), the XW-specific fundamentals (the EU beet campaign and government tender activity), and the White Premium itself as a distinct, trackable relationship.